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opening. Not a single *saaya* (auspicious date) in either the previous year or the current year has passed without weddings at the hotel,” says Dillip Rajakarier, Group CEO of Minor International, which owns Anantara Hotels & Resorts.

However, the creation of a true luxury hub goes beyond just building hotels. As Jaipur reinvents itself, it is emerging as one of India’s most competitive luxury clusters—and there is no shortage of examples to prove it.

Take Punit Balana. The Jaipur-based designer celebrated 10 years of his label with the opening of his flagship store in the city—his third after Delhi and Mumbai. The celebrations included a fashion show, set against the backdrop of the iconic Rambagh Palace, and had Bollywood actor Ananya Pandey as the showstopper. “Jaipur has truly established itself as a hub for craftsmanship and textiles. Its rich cultural heritage, combined with excellent connectivity, makes it easily accessible to a global audience. What makes it truly special is its unique pace, neither too fast nor too slow, which gives the city its own beauty,” says Balana, who has seen a 50%

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1. FASHION FORWARD

Punit Balana at his fashion show with Ananya Pandey as the showstopper

2. MARVELLOUS MEENAKARI

Museum of Meenakari Heritage

3. A NEW WAY OF SEEING

Jaipur Centre for Arts